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Zalo

me.grow

RMIT University Vietnam, Saigon South Campus



Topic 7: Building Team Capability & Growth

Dr Thao Luong

About this session

Strong teams start with understanding ourselves and grow through understanding how we connect.

Today is an opportunity to step away from *doing the work* and explore how we show up, work together, and contribute to the team as a whole.

Using LEGO® Serious Play®, we will make our thinking visible, hear every voice, and build a shared picture of the team.

By the end of this session, you will:

- Explore your strengths, values, working style and unique contribution;
- Appreciate what others bring and the spirit that makes the team unique;
- Recognize how individual roles, relationships, and influences shape the way we work;
- Reflect on your Real-Time Identity – who you need to be to contribute at your best.

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INTHRFACE
Complete Certification
Trained facilitator in the LEGO® SERIOUS PLAY® methodology
The Brickmind Community





Agenda

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1. Your Identity on the Team
2. Team Life (or the Spirit of the Team)
3. The Team Landscape
   (or “How is the Team connected?”)
4. (Homework) Real Time Identity for YOU

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Ready for what’s next



About me ☺



Dr. Thao Luong

Senior Program Manager – Lecturer
(Human Resource Management)



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Education:

- Ph.D. in Knowledge Science, Japan Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (Japan)
- Master in HRM, Griffith University (Australia)
- Bachelor in Business, University of Economics HCMC (Vietnam)
- CHT & CHE (American Hotel and Lodging Educational Institute)
- Trained Facilitator in the LEGO® Serious Play® Methodology

Work Experience (15 years): Sales (PepsiCo International), HR (FrieslandCampina), Corporate Training (Saigontourist Group), VP (Saigontourist Hospitality College)

Our Playbook





- Be fully present
- Try to earn the playground money for your team
- Honor others' opinions
- Put cellphones away and on vibrate (if possible)
- Please don't hurt anyone
- Use **burning** thoughts for questions
- Relax and have fun
- "Through discipline comes freedom" - Aristotle



The History of LEGO® Serious Play®

From a toy to a powerful tool for people, teams and organisations

Same bricks.
A bigger purpose.













1932–1950s

The LEGO® Foundation

Ole Kirk Kristiansen founds LEGO in 1932 in Denmark, with a vision to inspire children's creativity through play.

"Only the best is good enough."
– Ole Kirk Kristiansen

1958

The LEGO® Brick as a System

The modern LEGO® brick with a stud-and-tube coupling system is launched, enabling endless possibilities to build, take apart and rebuild.

A simple system with limitless possibilities.

1990s

From Product to Process

The LEGO Group begins exploring how LEGO bricks can be used beyond play — as a tool for serious thinking, innovation and organisational development.

Realising the potential of LEGO beyond the toy box.

1999–2001

The Birth of LEGO® Serious Play®

The LEGO Group, in partnership with professors Johan Roos and Bart Victor (IMD, Switzerland), develops the LEGO® Serious Play® (LSP) method to help organisations address complex challenges through hands-on, reflective dialogue.

A new way to think, together.

2000s–2010s

Growing Adoption

LSP is adopted globally by organisations, facilitators and educators across sectors — from business and government to non-profits and education — to unlock insights, build shared understanding and drive positive change.

From boardrooms to classrooms, around the world.

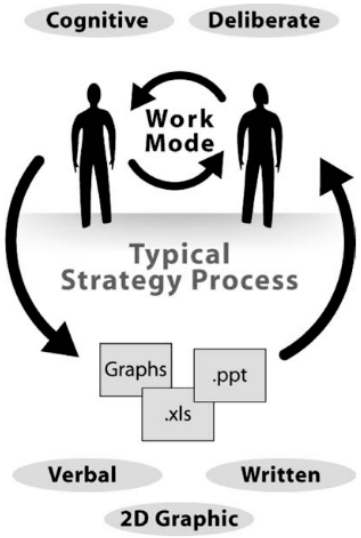
Today

Continuing the Journey

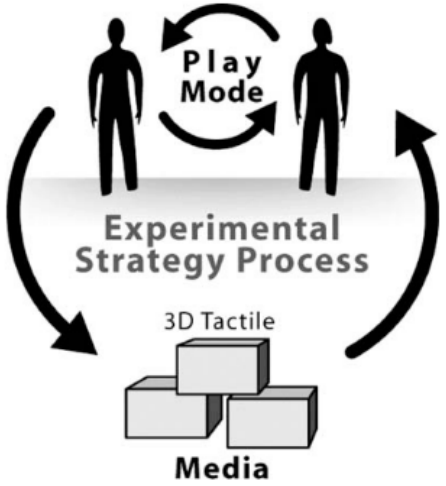
LEGO® Serious Play® continues to evolve, helping people and organisations navigate complexity, imagine new possibilities and build a better future — one brick at a time.

Different questions. Brighter futures.

LEGO® Serious Play® (LSP®) Methodology Origins







Typical strategy discussions are cognitive-based

- However, humans have emotion and are social creatures important in strategy making;
- Their strategy is to acknowledge all of these elements (cognitive, emotional and social aspects) that make us humans done through "Serious Play"

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Roos, J, Victor, B & Statler, M 2004, 'Playing seriously with strategy', Long Range Planning, vol. 37, no. 6, pp. 549–568.

LSP® is indeed grounded in a variety of theories

- Organizational Identity (Albert & Whetten; Clegg)
- Heedful Interaction (Weick)
- Imagination (Kearney)
- Constructivism (Piaget)
- Complex Adaptive Systems theory (Kaufmann)
- Fitness Landscape (Kaufmann)
- Organizational Epistemology (von Krogh & Roos)
- Constructionism (Papert)
- Coherance (Lissack & Roos)
- The Hand (Wilson)
- Bricolage (Levi-Strauss)
- Active Imagination (Jung)
- Autopoiesis in social systems (Luhmann)
- Autopoiesis in natural systems (Maturana & Varela)

Meet Our RMIT University LSP® Facilitators

A/Prof. Elaine Chew

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(Management Dept.)

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(Entrepreneurship)

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Dr. Thao Luong

Senior Program Manager,
Lecturer (HRM)

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Mr. Vincent Quach

Lecturer, Tourism and
Hospitality Management

ha.quachvan@rmit.edu.vn



Ground Rules



1. Build as you want – there is no right and wrong!
2. Only you decide the meaning of your model!
3. You own your model and the story about it!
4. If you get stuck, just build (hands on)!
5. You are all committed to building and have the right to explain!
6. Be curious – listen with your eyes & ask questions about other participants' models!
7. Give you mobile and computer a break!

4 NO GO's

1. Do not evaluate (I like – dislike…)
2. Do not assess (I find, I think…)
3. Do not interpret (To me,…)
4. Do not go beyond the model (How did you feel when…)



LSP® Skill Building – Metaphors



- Metaphor is an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to have similar characteristics to that person or object (e.g., “the mind is an ocean”)
- Metaphors help us to:
  - communicate complex ideas
  - make sense of something that is otherwise hard to put in words
  - think about reality in different ways
  - explore possibilities we may be afraid to explore in real life

Let us pass this point!

- Even when you can not plan it, you can build it.
- When you do something with your hands, a complex process takes over that expands the experience.
- Trust your hands, let them choose the bricks they want.
- Do not get stuck in the design.



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Ready for what’s next

LEGO® Serious Play® (LSP®) – Real Time Identity

LSP® Real Time Identity (RTI) for the Team is a process that helps moving a group of individuals to become what we call a **Real Team**.

Real Team: Realize the team's full potential – quickly and effectively.



LSP® RTI for the Team is not about what the team does, but rather on **how** the team does it. It is thus about how the teams behaves towards one another, and the tasks the team is facing in everyday life. It is about strategy for the team!

From acting randomly

From being distinct job functions

From having to live with frustrations

From individual identities

From just looking at individual abilities



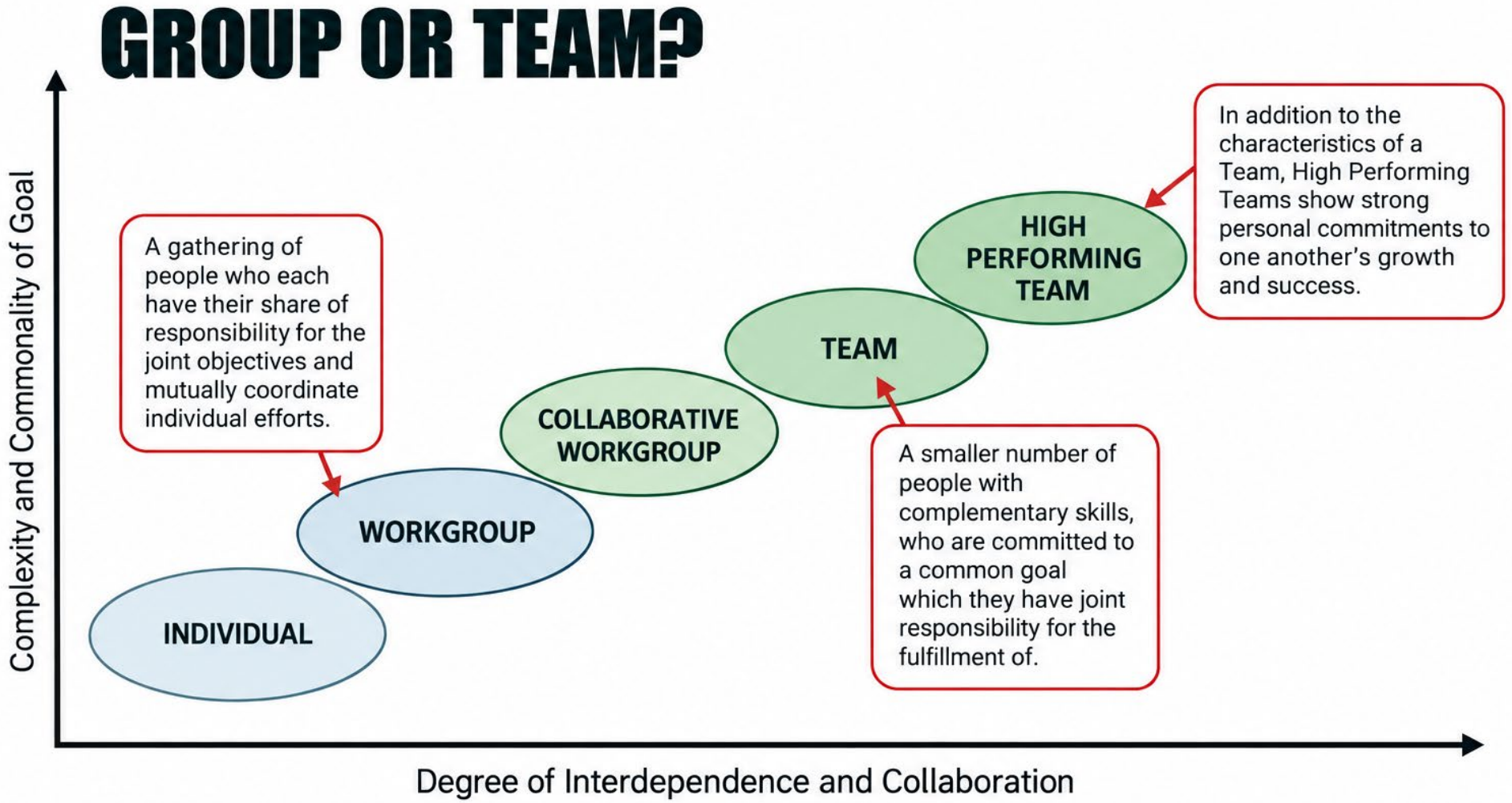
To recognizing the mutual benefits

To having a shared identity

To changing things for the better

To being effectively integrated

To acting deliberately



Source: Kanaga, K., & Kossler, M. E. (2001). *How to form a team : five keys to high performance*. Centre for Creative Leadership.

YOU	ME: Known to ME	ME: Unknown to ME
Known to others	**Open** Information about me that I and others know	**External Perspective** Information about me that others know but I don't
Unknown to others	**Possible you** Information about me that I know but others don't	**Unknown** Information about me that neither I nor others know

Self-disclosure

Feedback



The Johari Window: A help to introduce the first section

1. Your Identity on the Team

Who are you today on this team?

This section invites participants to reflect on how they show up in their current team, what they currently contribute, and what more they could bring to strengthen collaboration. Through **LEGO® Serious Play®**, participants explore their current and possible role in supporting stronger alignment, teamwork, and performance at Zalo.

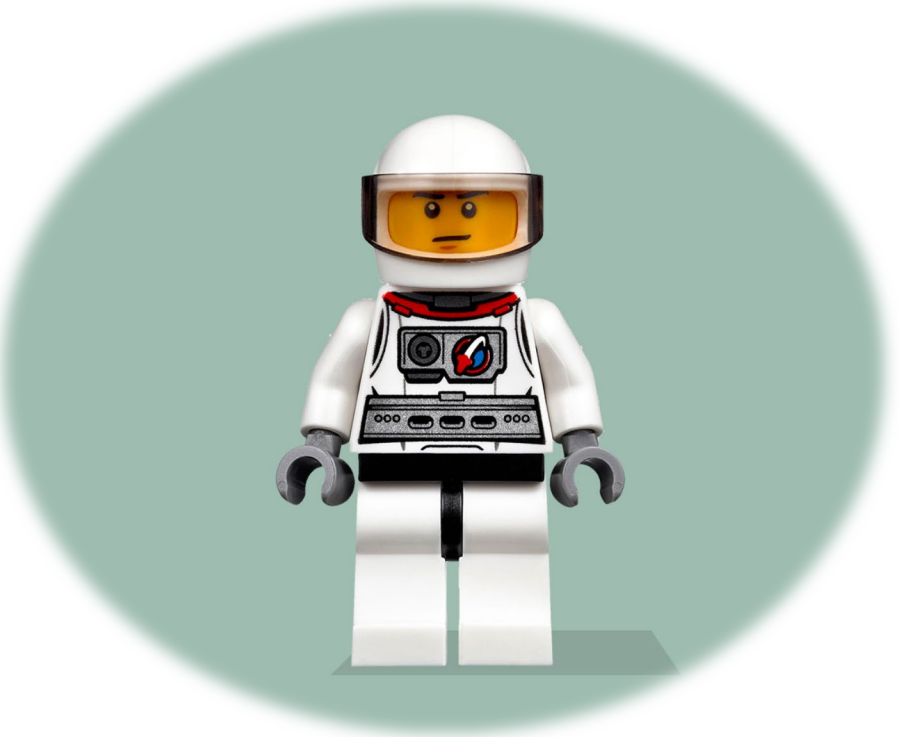


1. Your Identity on the Team

THE IDEA:

Any individual identity consists of:

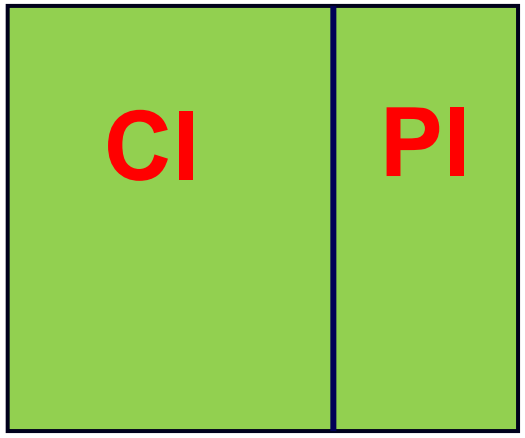
- A Core Identity **(CI)**: The qualities, values, and strengths that define how you naturally contribute when working in your team
- An External Identity **(EI)**: How others see and experience you in your team
- A Possible Identity **(PI)**: The additional value, behaviors, or strengths you could bring to support stronger collaboration and alignment, but have not yet fully shown



1. You as a Team Member

CI – Who am I in this team?
PI – What could I bring to the team?

REAL TIME



We are working with your **professional identity**: your competencies, experience, personality

Activity 1 (Individual -10 mins)

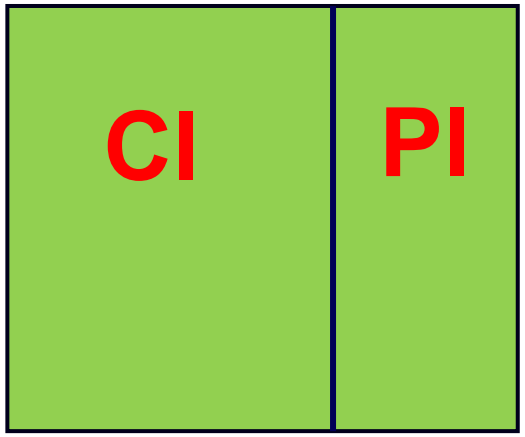
- Individually, use a plate to build two models:
  - On 2/3 of the plate, build a model of your **Core Identity (CI)** on the team: who are you in this team and what could you bring to the team?
  - On the remaining third, build a model of your **Possible Identity (PI)** on the team: what could you bring to the team?


LEGO
10:00

1. You as a Team Member

REAL TIME

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PI – What could I bring to the team?



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We are working with your **professional identity**: your competencies, experience, personality

- Take a photo of your model, upload to the Padlet
- Share with your group (2 mins/person for sharing)

“Who is your external I, on the team?”

As a team member certain sides of you are put forward in public. However, you will not always be able to see what others see. Thus, you will have to rely on the fact that others can build your external identity, as experienced by the team. After this, add the model of your external I to your core identity model.

You are of course the only one, who can alter your core identity and desired identity.

Challenge A: How do you see others?

The facilitator will give you the name of another team member. Then build a small model on behalf of that member. The model must represent a side of the person’s external identity of which you see.

Challenge B: Story about what others see.

Tell the story and then give the model to the other team member – do not tell who the model represents, before the story is told. Collect all the identities subsequently.



Complicated and mysterious



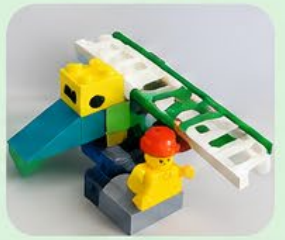
Available but not to get hold on



Knows exactly what is happening around you



The influence is extensive



Always ready to rescue others



Keen and transparent

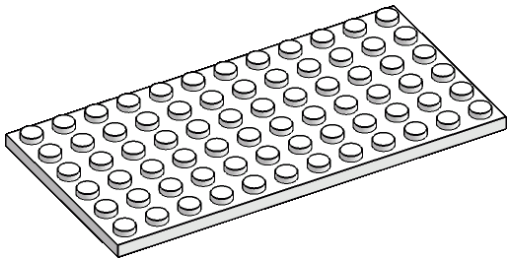
“Who is your external I, on the team?”

EI – How do colleagues experience working with me?



<u>Activity 2</u> (Individual -10 mins)

- The facilitator will assign you **another participant** *(please do not reveal the name at first)*.
- Use a **plate** to build a model that represents **how this person is experienced on the team**.
- On ¾ of the plate, build **2 prominent features** of how this person works *(e.g. communication style, responsiveness, openness, reliability, coordination, problem-solving)*
- On ¼ of the plate, build **1 recommendation** that could help this person strengthen collaboration across departments
- Share the story of your model and let others guess who it represents
- Then **give the model to that person** as feedback for reflection.



“Who is your external I, on the team?”

EI – How do colleagues experience working with me?

REAL TIME



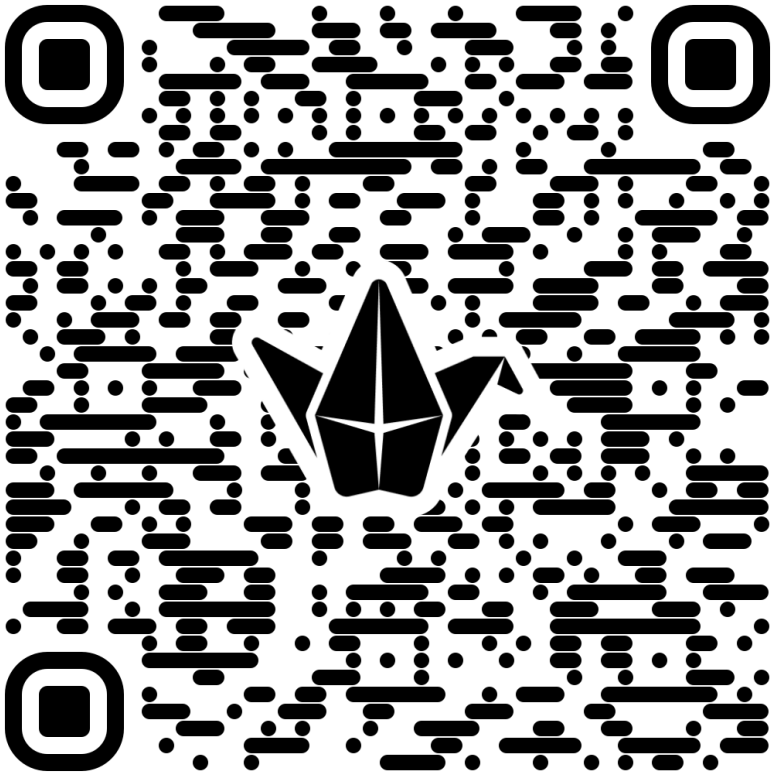
Remember:

- We are focusing on the person’s **professional role and team behavior**
- Focus on **observable behaviors**, not assumptions or personal judgments
- When giving a recommendation, focus on what could strengthen collaboration, coordination, and trust
- Build from a current, real-work perspective
- Be honest, respectful, and constructive
- The purpose is to support reflection and stronger cross-functional leadership, not criticism.


LEGO
10:00

“Who is your external I, on the team?”

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2. Team Life (or Spirit of the Team)

The Feeling of what we do, and how we do it:
"The Spirit of the Team"

"Team Life" seems to have its own life. All team members are affected by it, and they themselves affect it in different dimensions. Team Life is larger and more persistent than any single individual – regardless of the particular case being good or bad.

Everyone experiences the impact of Team Life in their own way, but there can be no doubt, that your Team Life has an impact on each of the identities included in the team, and thereby make it up.

The challenge: What and how is the team actually?

Build the 2 aspects of your Team Life as you think best characterizes the team's practice and has the strongest impact on the way the team works and operates.

Positive or negative – if it characterizes your Team Life, then build it!



Independent contributions and initiatives are encouraged



Introverted and self-sufficient – but it goes fast.

2. Team Life (or Spirit of the Team)

Activity 3 (Individual -10 mins)

- Build the **two aspects of your Team Life** as you think best characterize the team's practice.
- These can be **positive or negative**: if they strongly shape team's collaboration, build them!
- Place all individual Team Life models in the middle of the table, so their positions also tell a story.
- Be ready to explain:
  - ❖ what each aspect represents
  - ❖ how it affects collaboration in the team
  - ❖ whether it helps or hurts alignment and performance



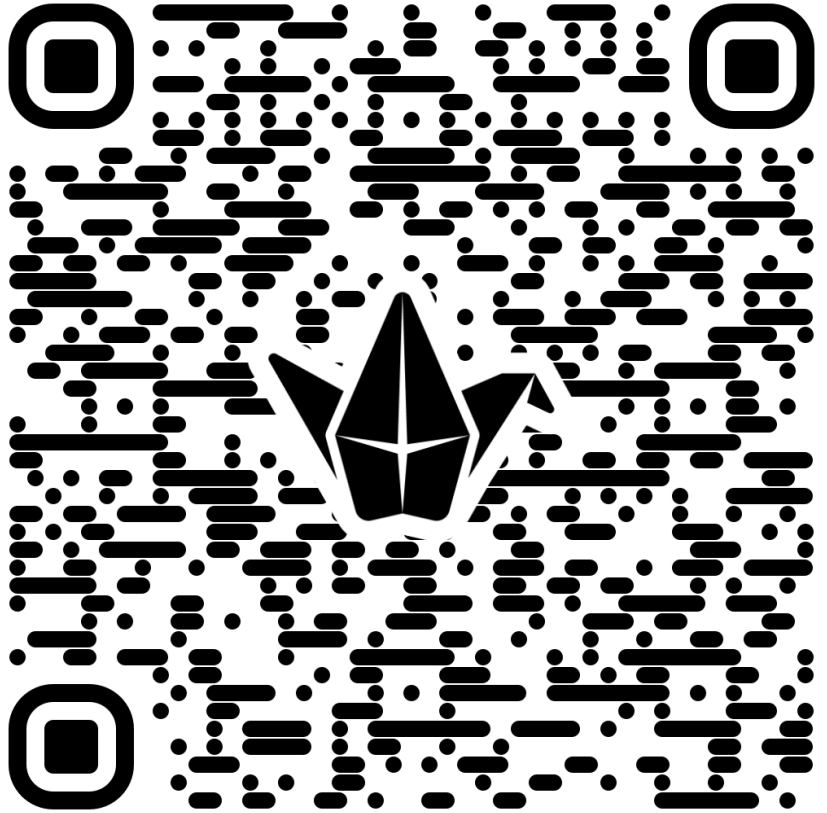



LEGO
10:00

2. Team Life (or Spirit of the Team)

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Enablers and Barriers to Team Life

Enablers

- Shared goals and priorities
- Open communication across functions
- Trust and mutual respect
- Clear roles and decision rights
- Timely coordination and follow-through
- Leadership support and a collaboration mindset

Barriers

- Silo thinking and functional turf
- Conflicting KPI or priorities
- Unclear ownership
- Delayed communication or information gaps
- Lack of trust or psychological safety
- Weak follow-through or inconsistent leadership signals

Recognizing these enablers and barriers help us move to the final question:

How can we strengthen cross-functional collaboration in practice

3. The Team Landscape

"How is the Team connected?"

Whether we realize it or not, any team is functioning as a complex organism with many complicated internal connections. For example, management and support are among the more obvious connections. Affiliation and feelings are less obvious, but equally important.

Naturally, each connection is experienced very differently by the parties involved. Thus, there may be very different images and ideas of how the connections operate in practice. Therefore, be prepared to negotiate on the interpretation of a connection – or at least agree that variations do occur.

The Challenge - What is your part in all of this?

1. Build, at the most, two important connections between yourself and a part of the Team Life model you feel most connected to.
2. Build, at the most, two important connections between yourself and two other identity models on the table.
3. Now tell the story of your Team Life and its connections!



You can make connections to your core identity or external identity!

3. The Team Landscape

“How is the Team connected?”

- A **connection** is also a metaphor, representing the relationship between people.
- The purpose is to visualize the **nature of collaboration** by building connections between individual contribution and shared ways of working
- The exercise helps make visible:
  - where collaboration is strong
  - where dependencies are critical
  - where disconnects, bottlenecks, or weak links may exist



3. The Team Landscape

"How is the Team connected?"



Activity 4 (Individual – 10 mins)

- Build up to two key connections between yourself and the collaboration dynamic you feel closest to
- Build up to two important connections between yourself and two other people or functions on the table that are most important to your work.
- Use the connections to show the nature of the relationship, for example:
  - strong or weak
  - direct or indirect
  - supportive or difficult
  - frequent or limited
- Share the story of your landscape and what it reveals about your team.

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3. The Team Landscape

“How is the Team connected?”



How does it all tie together?

- What conclusions can you draw about your team from the models and discussions?

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4. (Homework) Real Time Identity for YOU

Who you are, deep down.

REAL TIME IDENTITY
For YOU



Be part of a team, while you stick to who you are.



Even with the worst frustrations and chaos, there are opportunities.

OBJECTIVES OF THE RTI FOR YOU PROCESS

Discover who you really are deep inside and get a clear picture on how you operate in work/life.

Learn a better way of communicating.

Pick up skills that make you an even more effective partner in your business while being in accordance with who you are deep inside.

Become better at adapting and responding to changes.

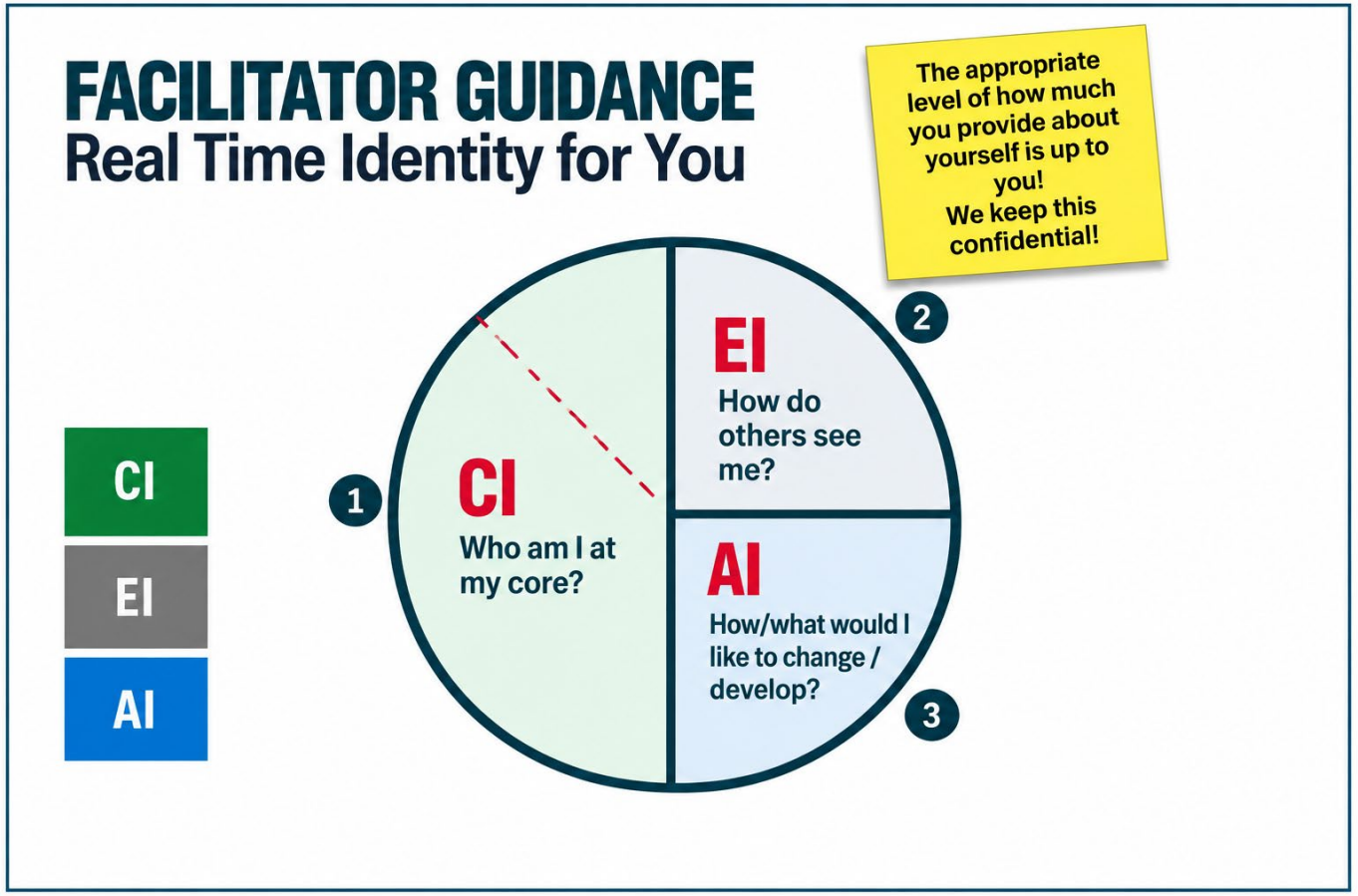
RTI can be used as a flexible consultant tool for individual and team processes in relation to changes, learning, communication, optimization, transformation and cohesion.



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4. (Homework) Real Time Identity for YOU

Who you are, deep down.



4. (Homework) Real Time Identity for YOU

Final Discussion

At this workshop, you have given a chance to others, in your team or in your workplace, to get to know more about you.

You have created:

- An important statement and an overview of yourself, that you have shared with others.
- An expression of how you think others see you.
- Your desired identity and you have explored it.

4. (Homework) Real Time Identity for YOU

Action Items?

- It is now time to leave the world of play and move back to work.
- We hope you will return with new knowledge about yourself as well as better understanding of the people around you.

Exercises:

- Write down 3-4 areas that you want to work with when you return to work.

For example, you can think of new ways to interact with others or consider how you can begin to develop the conditions making your potential or desired identity realized.

Thank you!

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Ready for what's next